



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Classical Academy of Sarasota

School Website: <https://tcasarasota.com/>

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**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**SCL MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

The Classical Academy of Sarasota (TCA) presents a publicly accessible program and culture that is strongly aligned with classical education principles across all six rubric categories. Core elements such as the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); a history-centered, canon-based curriculum; explicit cultivation of virtue and character; Socratic and rhetoric-informed pedagogy; a living, model-centered faculty ethos; and a proactive partnership with parents and the community are evident in the website content. The school's motto Do the Good. Learn the True. Love the Beautiful. explicitly foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty, which anchors Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) in a CLASSICAL orientation. The Seven Hills of TCA and Virtues & Habits pages reinforce a coherent classical mission focused on formation, virtue, and a communal life that includes parent engagement and small-community dynamics. The Lower and Upper School materials, Teaching the Timeline, and College/Career counseling pages collectively demonstrate curriculum breadth (including Latin, canonical literature, primary sources, and history in a Trivium-informed structure) as well as pedagogical practices that include memory work, chanting, and Socratic discussions. Across categories, positive keyword indicators (truth, virtue, Great Books, history, Latin, scholé, memory work, etc.) substantially outweigh negative indicators, with minimal reliance on contemporary "workforce-ready" framing or project-based/directed constructs that would signal a tension with classical aims. The aggregate rating is CLASSICAL.

Key evidentiary highlights:

- Motto invoking the transcendentals: truth, goodness, beauty (Do the Good. Learn the True. Love the Beautiful.)
- Canonical, history- and virtue-centered curriculum guided by Western classics; explicit emphasis on the Great Books/first-source documents and history as the backbone of learning (e.g., "first-source documents," "great works of literature," historical chronology across the trivium) ,
- Trivium-centric curriculum with Latin instruction starting early; history instruction tied to chronological study; emphasis on mastery and rhetoric in upper grades
- Pedagogy includes singing/chanting and memory work in the lower grades; Socratic/seminar-style discourse and rhetorical training in upper grades ,
- Faculty as living curriculum and a culture of mentorship and virtuous exemplars; explicit statements about teacher roles and small-community mentoring
- Strong parent partnership orientation and visible parent-facing engagement (parent talks, book-study/formations, open campus ethos) ,

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

**Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**

## Evidence

- The school's public-facing motto foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty as central ideals (Do the Good. Learn the True. Love the Beautiful.). This places transcendental moral realism at the heart of education and character formation.
- The Seven Hills of TCA articulate foundational virtues and classical aims (classical education, virtue, small community, etc.), signaling a metaphysical and moral orientation embedded in school culture.
- Virtue is presented as central to the educational enterprise (Virtue as the foundation woven into all activities; a focus on character formation).
- Supporting lower- and middle-school pedagogy emphasizes wonder and reverence in learning, aligning with a metaphysical frame (wonder as a gateway to the transcendent in learning).

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wonder; reverence; liturgical/communal implication (via liturgical-adjacent phrasing in the public ethos); memory work; chord with scholé.
- Negative indicators: Minimal explicit signaling of secularism or relativism; no strong presence of secular-nexus "values clarification" or purely relativistic framing in the public materials I reviewed.

## Why this rating

- The motto and the Seven Hills documents place explicit focus on transcendentals and virtue, with a communal, virtue-centered ethos. The public content compounds these signals with memory/chant-based pedagogy and a strong emphasis on character as foundational, which aligns with CLASSICAL rather than merely SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL profiles. The absence of explicit theology texts or liturgical worship in the public-facing materials does not negate the metaphysical orientation evidenced by transcendentals and virtue-centric framing. Overall alignment is CLASSICAL.

**Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**

## Evidence

- Emphasis on formation of virtue and wisdom as primary telos; education as formation and cultivation of humanity rather than mere job readiness (as reflected in the mission and motto, and the Seven Hills framing).
- Orientation to truth, goodness, and beauty as legitimate and knowable ideals; emphasis on human flourishing and "cultivating virtue" consistent with classical paideia aims. The motto explicitly echoes this triad.
- The curriculum and pedagogy stress formation through memory, virtue, and mastery rather than purely instrumental outcomes; programs like Great Books/history and Latin support formation through canonical learning.

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation; cultivate virtue; liberal education; paideia; Great Books, tradition; permanent questions; teleology toward wisdom and human excellence; scholé (restful contemplation).
- Negative indicators: Minimal emphasis on "workforce preparation" language; the site emphasizes formation over job-readiness.

## Why this rating

- The school's stated aims and supporting curricular/practitioner content align strongly with CLASSICAL goals centered on formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty rather than a predominant focus on job-market outcomes. This category is CLASSICAL.

**Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**

## Evidence

- Explicit reference to Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; and quadrivium concepts) and the role of the trivium as foundational. This is reinforced by the Seven Hills and The Classical Education material.
- History is treated as a throughline across the curriculum; the timeline/history pedagogy is clearly described (Teaching the Timeline) with chronology across grades and repeated revisits in the grammar/-logic/rhetoric phases.
- Great Books / primary sources and engagement with canonical works are emphasized (first-source documents; Western canon; great literature). This is reflected in the The Classical Education materials and Seven Hills framing.
- Latin instruction is highlighted as foundational and begins early; Latin learning is woven into overall literacy and thinking development.

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books/primary sources, history/Western civilization, Latin, first-source documents, reading of canonical texts, intellectual integration (interdisciplinary approach).
- Negative indicators: The materials critique or avoid exclusivity of “project-based” or purely experiential learning in favor of traditional canonical learning; this aligns with classical pedagogy rather than a modern “project-first” tilt. The explicit negative signals from the lexicon appear to be largely absent in the public site materials.

## Why this rating

- The curriculum squarely foregrounds classical pillars (grammar/logic/rhetoric, history, Great Books/primary sources, Latin), with clear emphasis on integrated historical-literary-cultural study. This is CLASSICAL.

**Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

## Evidence

- Early-grade pedagogy emphasizes singing/chanting and memory work to deepen memory and delight (scholé-like aspects).
- Upper-grade pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training (speech/declamation and oratory activities) consistent with classical pedagogy.
- The school describes becoming proficient in logic and rhetoric (upper grades) and uses a “living curriculum” through teacher modeling and mentorship, consistent with classical pedagogy.

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Scholé (contemplative/restful learning), memory work, chanting/narration/recitation, Socratic seminars, dialectic, rhetoric, oratory, debate, living curriculum, teacher as mentor.
- Negative indicators: The explicit negative signals from the classical lexicon (e.g., exclusive reliance on experiential/project-based learning or constructivist approaches) do not appear to predominate in the site’s pedagogy; the public content emphasizes teacher-led, canonical, and dialogic methods.

## Why this rating

- Pedagogy integrates contemplative/restful elements and memory-focused methods in the lower grades with Socratic seminar and rhetoric-focused activities in the upper grades, aligning with CLASSICAL pedagogy overall. This category is CLASSICAL.

**Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

## Evidence

- The Seven Hills presentation emphasizes faculty as the “living curriculum” and mentors, with small-community relationships and intentional mentorship within a rigorous program. This locates the faculty at the core of the school's formation.
- Public materials describe teachers as models of virtue and as guides within a close-knit community; there is emphasis on teacher-student and teacher-family collaboration.
- Founding leadership framing and the portrait of teacher expectations indicate a coherent faculty profile aligned with classical aims.

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; faculty as mentors/masters; portrait of a teacher; small-community mentoring; teacher-student partnership; professional virtue modeling.
- Negative indicators: No explicit signals in the public content of “facilitators on the side” or purely credential-driven jargon lacking classical context; the available materials describe a traditional, teacher-centered model consistent with classical aims.

## Why this rating

- The faculty is positioned as central to the school's formation and classical mission, with strong emphasis on mentorship, virtue, and living curriculum. This is CLASSICAL.

**Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL**

## Evidence

- The Founders emphasize a partnership with parents—“a beautiful partnership between the school and the family,” with parents actively engaged and continuing to learn alongside the school. This directly supports a co-teaching model and ongoing parent formation.
- The Seven Hills section highlights ongoing parent involvement (Friday Morning Parent Talks), a House System, family events, and a culture of open communication and community formation.
- The school explicitly notes open campus visitation and a family-centric, collaborative ethos.

## Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; book clubs; family liturgy alignment; open campus; parent talks; a hospitable, engaged community.
- Negative indicators: No evidence of a consumer-centric, transactional parent relationship; the content supports active parental formation and involvement rather than a customer-service model.

## Why this rating

- The public materials demonstrate a robust, classical-aligned partnership with parents and an engaged community that supports formation and shared responsibility in education. This category is CLASSICAL.

## Aggregate Ranking

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable for an aggregate CLASSICAL rating. The school already demonstrates strong alignment with the Six Essential Elements. If desired, further strengthening could come from explicitly detailing theology or liturgical/community practices on the site to reflect a deeper religious-metaphysical program for families seeking explicit liturgical alignment, while preserving the current virtuous and canon-rich approach.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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